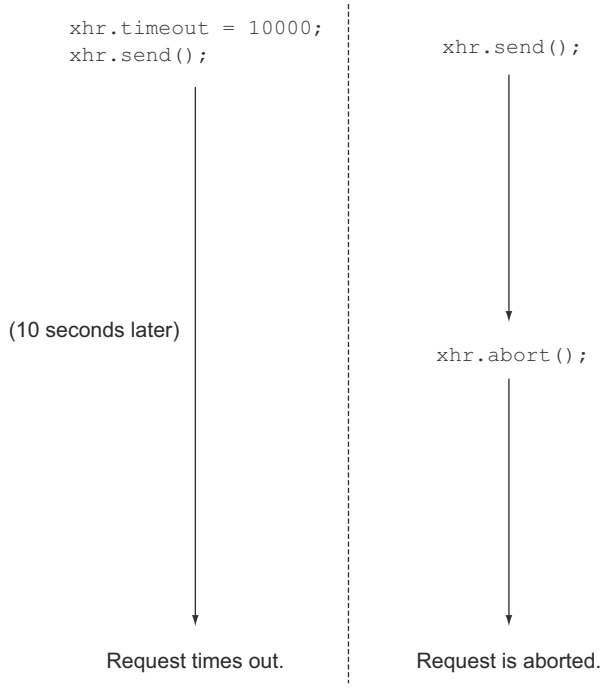


Figure 2.4 Canceling a request that is still in progress using the `timeout` property and `abort` method

If the HTTP request has a request body, the body can be passed in as a parameter to the `send` method as follows:

```
xhr.send('request body goes here');
```

Once the `send` method is called, the HTTP request is sent to the server. Even though the request has been sent, there are still a couple of ways to cancel the request. First, the `timeout` property can be used to ensure that the request doesn't exceed a certain number of milliseconds. Setting the `timeout` property to `10000` will kill the request after 10 seconds. The default value for the `timeout` property is `0`, which means there is no timeout, and the request will continue until the server responds. Second, the client can manually kill the request by using the `abort` method. Calling the `abort` method will abort the request immediately. Figure 2.4 shows how to use the `timeout` property and the `abort` method.

When the server receives a cross-origin request, it determines whether or not the request is allowed, and replies accordingly. Chapter 3 will cover how the server replies to cross-origin requests. But for now, let's assume there is a successful HTTP response, and look at how to handle it.

2.3.2 Handling the HTTP response

The `XMLHttpRequest` object handles the server's response through a set of events. Events are functions that are invoked at specific moments in the lifecycle of an HTTP